

Θέων ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεύς

Ptolemy's Tables Explained by Theon of Alexandria

eul_aid: spw

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Μαθηματικά [Mathematics](#)

Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Theon of Alexandria was a Greek mathematician and astronomer of the 4th century CE, active in Alexandria during the reigns of Theodosius I and Arcadius. He held a position at the Museum, Alexandria's institution of higher learning, and is noted as its last attested member. He is most widely remembered as the father and teacher of the philosopher Hypatia.

His scholarly output consisted of influential commentaries and editions of foundational texts. Theon produced the standard commentary on Ptolemy's *Almagest* and a definitive edition of Euclid's *Elements*, which included his own notes and alternative proofs. He also wrote a commentary on Ptolemy's *Handy Tables* and a treatise on the astrolabe.

Theon played a crucial role in preserving and transmitting classical Greek mathematics and astronomy. His editions, which incorporated corrections and updates, became essential textbooks for Byzantine, Islamic, and later scholars. He serves as a vital link between antiquity and the medieval period, both through his widely circulated works and through his famous daughter, Hypatia.

Works (5)

- Ὑπόμνημα εἰς Πτολεμαίου Μαθηματικὴν Σύνταξιν Α'-Δ' · [Commentary-Ptolemy's Mathematical Syntax I–IV](#) · 738 passages
- Ὑπόμνημα εἰς τοὺς προχείρους Πτολεμαίου κανόνες · [Commentary-the Handy Tables of Ptolemy, Books 1–3](#) · 153 passages
- Ἐπιγράμματα · [Epigrams](#) · 9 passages
- Εἰς τοὺς προχείρους κανόνες · [On the Ready Rules](#) · 99 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · [Testimonies](#) · 2 passages